TYPES OF NEW DIPLOMACY

Palmer and Perkins noted the most effective forms of diplomacy that could be perceived in the twentieth century till the present. The chief forms of diplomacy, among others, are democratic diplomacy, totalitarian democracy, summit diplomacy, personal diplomacy, diplomacy by conference, and parliamentary diplomacy.

Democratic Diplomacy: This had, particularly become the commonest form of diplomacy by the turn of twentieth century. The participation of the people in the politics of a state and the importance of public opinion led to a democratization of diplomacy where the governments were no longer the domain of aristocrats and diplomacy the sole affair of diplomats and ministers. But the experience of democratic diplomacy had not been satisfactory and a number of shortcomings had been pointed out by Nicolson. The most vehement criticism about democratic diplomacy is that it has come to be associated with the diplomacy of the market place. Further, Nicolson points out that the most potent source of danger is the “irresponsibility of the sovereign people” which means the failure of the common people to understand foreign policy intricacies which arise not from the absence of facts but from their ignorance and inability to apply their thoughts and intelligence to comprehend foreign affairs. Foreign affairs appear too foreign for them; as a result they create situations of embarrassment for diplomats and even strong public opinion may pull down a diplomatic negotiation or dog it with delay and imprecision.

Totalitarian Diplomacy: The rise of totalitarian states such as Germany, Italy, the Soviet Union after the First World War introduced a new but disturbing kind of diplomacy which was far different from its predecessors. These totalitarian states used modern techniques of military, political and psychological power to expand their spheres of influence, gain control over other states and subvert other regimes and further their aggressive policy of expansion. For this, they invoked doctrines of racial superiority, mysticism, materialism and militarism to further their national interests. Diplomacy came to be used as an instrument of national policy and, in doing so, the